

CHAPTER 2: Lunches & Dinners (The Satiety Meals)

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26. Karela (Bitter Gourd) & Onion Sabzi

GI Rating: Extremely Low (15) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Karela contains three active substances with anti-diabetic properties: charantin, vicine, and an insulin-like compound known as polypeptide-p. These work together to lower blood glucose levels. Sautéing with onions adds chromium, which helps improve the body's response to insulin.
- **Ingredients:** 2 medium Karelas (sliced thin), 2 medium Onions (sliced), ½ tsp Turmeric, 1 tsp Coriander powder, ½ tsp Amchur (Dry Mango Powder), ½ tsp Fennel seeds, 1 tbsp Mustard Oil, Salt to taste.
- **Method:** Rub sliced karela with salt and let it sit for 10 minutes, then squeeze out the bitter juice. Heat mustard oil to the smoking point in a pan, let it cool slightly, then add fennel seeds. Add sliced onions and sauté until golden. Stir in the squeezed karela, turmeric, and salt. Cook on low-medium heat uncovered for 10-12 minutes until light brown and crisp. Stir in coriander powder and amchur at the end; mix well.
- **Pair with:** 1 Jowar Roti and a bowl of fresh curd.

27. Cauliflower Rice Vegetable Biryani

GI Rating: Low (18) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** White basmati rice is a staple that unfortunately causes rapid blood sugar spikes in diabetics due to its high starch content. By replacing rice with grated cauliflower (cauliflower rice), this recipe slashes carbohydrates by 85% and adds essential fiber, vitamin C, and folate, preserving the full biryani experience.
- **Ingredients:** 1 medium head of Cauliflower, 1 cup mixed chopped vegetables (French beans, carrots, green peas), 1 small Onion (sliced), 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, 1 Bay leaf (Tej Patta), 2 Cardamoms, 2 Cloves, 1 small stick Cinnamon, ½ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tsp Ghee, Salt to taste.
- **Method:** Grate the cauliflower florets into rice-sized grains using a food processor or box grater. Heat ghee in a deep pan and add the bay leaf, cardamoms, cloves, and cinnamon. Sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste until golden. Add the chopped vegetables, turmeric, garam masala, and salt. Cook for 5 minutes until vegetables are half-cooked. Stir in the cauliflower rice. Cover and steam on low heat for 4-5 minutes (do not add water, as cauliflower releases its own moisture). Fluff and serve hot.

28. Chicken Palak (Spinach Chicken)

GI Rating: Zero/Low (Under 10) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 25m

- **Why it works:** Chicken breast provides pure, lean protein that stimulates the release of glucagon, an antagonist to insulin, helping stabilize blood sugar. Blending it with a generous amount of spinach increases the intake of dietary fiber, magnesium, and iron, making this a highly insulin-sensitizing dish.
- **Ingredients:** 250g Chicken breast (cut into cubes), 1 large bunch of fresh Spinach (Palak), 1 medium Onion (chopped), 1 Tomato (pureed), 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp Cumin powder, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tbsp

Oil, Salt to taste.

- **Method:** Blanch the spinach leaves in boiling water for 2 minutes, plunge into cold water, and blend into a smooth puree. Heat oil in a pan, sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste until golden brown. Add tomato puree, cumin powder, and salt. Cook until oil separates. Add chicken pieces and sauté for 5 minutes to seal the juices. Pour in the spinach puree, cover, and simmer on low heat for 12-15 minutes until chicken is tender. Sprinkle garam masala before serving.
- **Pair with:** Cauliflower rice or 1 Multigrain Roti.

29. Bhindi Masala (Mustard Oil Okra)

GI Rating: Low (20) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Okra (Bhindi) contains a thick, viscous mucilage that binds to sugar molecules in the intestinal tract, slowing down their absorption. Cooking it in cold-pressed mustard oil adds monounsaturated fatty acids (MUFAs), which improve lipid profiles in type 2 diabetics.
- **Ingredients:** 250g Okra (Bhindi, washed, dried, and sliced), 1 Onion (chopped), ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ½ tsp Turmeric, 1 tsp Coriander powder, ½ tsp Kashmiri Red Chilli powder, 1 tbsp lemon juice (acid lowers GI), 1 tbsp Mustard Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat mustard oil in a pan until smoking. Add cumin seeds and let them crackle. Add chopped onions and sauté until light pink. Add the sliced okra and cook on medium heat without covering (to prevent it from becoming slimy). Drizzle lemon juice over the okra. After 8-10 minutes, when the okra is tender, add turmeric, coriander powder, red chilli powder, and salt. Stir gently and cook for another 3 minutes.

30. Fish Tikka Masala (Dairy-Free)

GI Rating: Zero/Low (Under 10) | Prep: 20m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Fish is an excellent source of lean protein and Omega-3 fatty acids (EPA/DHA), which reduce cardiovascular inflammation—a major complication of diabetes. Keeping the gravy dairy-free by omitting heavy cream or cashew paste reduces saturated fat and calorie density.
- **Ingredients:** 250g firm fish fillets (like Rohu or Surmai), 1 tbsp lemon juice, ½ cup tomato puree, 1 onion (finely chopped), 1 tsp ginger-garlic paste, ½ tsp turmeric, ½ tsp cumin powder, ½ tsp garam masala, 1 tbsp oil, salt to taste.
- **Method:** Marinate the fish with lemon juice, a pinch of turmeric, and salt for 15 minutes. Pan-fry the fish in a non-stick pan with a teaspoon of oil until cooked on both sides, then set aside. Heat the remaining oil in a pan, sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste. Add tomato puree, turmeric, cumin powder, and salt. Cook until the gravy thickens and oil separates. Add the pan-fried fish pieces and garam masala. Simmer gently for 3-4 minutes.

31. Soya Chunks Matar (Peas) Curry

GI Rating: Low (25) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Soya chunks are a powerhouse of plant protein (over 50% by weight) and dietary fiber. When paired with green peas, which contain natural sugars, the high protein and fiber of soy blunt the overall glycemic response, making it a very safe and filling lunch.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup Soya chunks, ½ cup Green Peas, 1 Onion (chopped), 1 Tomato (chopped), 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tsp Cumin seeds, 1 tbsp Oil, Salt to taste.
- **Method:** Boil soya chunks in water for 5 minutes, rinse in cold water, squeeze out all excess water, and set aside. Heat oil in a pan, crackle cumin seeds, and sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste. Add tomatoes, turmeric, and salt; cook until soft. Add the soya chunks, green peas, and 1 cup of water. Cover and cook on medium heat for 8-10 minutes. Stir in garam masala and garnish with fresh coriander.

32. Eggplant (Baingan) Bharta

GI Rating: Low (15) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Eggplant is very low in calories and carbohydrates but rich in chlorogenic acid, an antioxidant that slows down glucose absorption in the gut and supports the reduction of blood lipids. Roasted with garlic and onions, it makes an excellent, fiber-filled dish.
- **Ingredients:** 1 large Eggplant (Baingan), 1 Onion (finely chopped), 2 Tomatoes (chopped), 4 cloves of Garlic (minced), 1 Green Chilli, ½ tsp red chilli powder, 1 tbsp Mustard Oil, Salt, fresh coriander.
- **Method:** Make a few slits in the eggplant and insert the garlic cloves. Roast the eggplant directly on an open flame, turning occasionally, until the skin is charred and the inside is soft. Let it cool, peel off the skin, and mash the pulp. Heat mustard oil in a pan, sauté onions and green chillies. Add tomatoes and cook until soft. Stir in the mashed eggplant pulp and roasted garlic, red chilli powder, and salt. Cook on medium heat for 5-7 minutes. Garnish with coriander.

33. Dry Rajma (Kidney Bean) Sundal

GI Rating: Low-Medium (35) | Prep: 10m (pre-boiled) | Cook: 5m

- **Why it works:** Traditional Rajma is often eaten in large quantities with white rice. This dry "Sundal" style preparation controls portion sizes, replaces rice entirely, and combines kidney beans with grated coconut for healthy fats, creating a high-fiber, high-protein snack or side dish.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup boiled Kidney Beans (Rajma), 2 tbsp grated fresh Coconut, ½ tsp Mustard seeds, 1 dry red chilli, 5-6 Curry leaves, pinch of Hing, 1 tsp Oil, Salt, lemon juice.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan and add mustard seeds, dry red chilli, curry leaves, and hing. Once the seeds crackle, add the boiled kidney beans and salt. Toss on medium heat for 2-3 minutes until heated through. Turn off the flame, add the grated coconut and fresh lemon juice, and mix well.

34. Mixed Dal Tadka (Panchratna Dal)

GI Rating: Medium (42) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Combining five different lentils (Toor, Moong, Masoor, Urad, and Chana) provides a complete profile of essential amino acids. The fiber in lentils slows starch digestion, while a simple ghee tempering adds healthy fats that further reduce the glycemic index.
- **Ingredients:** 2 tbsp each of Toor, Yellow Moong, Masoor, Urad, and Chana dal, 1 Onion (chopped), 1 Tomato (chopped), 1 tsp Ginger (grated), ½ tsp Turmeric, 1 tsp Cumin seeds, 1 pinch Hing, 1 tbsp Ghee, Salt.
- **Method:** Wash and soak the mixed dals for 30 minutes, then pressure cook with turmeric, salt, and 2.5 cups of water for 3-4 whistles. In a separate pan, heat ghee and add cumin seeds and hing. Add ginger, onions, and tomatoes; sauté until soft. Pour the boiled dal into the tempering, mix well, and simmer for 2-3 minutes.

35. Bottle Gourd (Lauki) Kofta (Non-Fried)

GI Rating: Low (25) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Deep-fried koftas are heavy in saturated fats and refined starches. This recipe uses grated bottle gourd (which is mostly water and fiber) mixed with chickpea flour, steamed instead of fried, and served in a light tomato gravy to create a satisfying, low-GI meal.
- **Ingredients:** 2 cups grated Bottle Gourd (Lauki), ½ cup Besan, ½ tsp Ajwain, 1 cup Tomato puree, 1 onion (chopped), 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tbsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Squeeze excess water from the grated lauki. Mix lauki with besan, ajwain, and salt. Shape into small balls and steam them in an idli steamer or a steamer rack for 10-12 minutes until firm. Heat oil in a pan, sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste. Add tomato puree, turmeric, and salt, and cook until oil separates. Add 1 cup of water, bring to a boil, then add the steamed koftas. Simmer for 5 minutes, then sprinkle with garam masala.

36. Mushroom Matar (No cashew cream)

GI Rating: Low (25) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Mushrooms are incredibly low-calorie and low-GI, containing beta-glucans that support immune health. Combining them with green peas in a light tomato-onion gravy without the traditional cashew cream or coconut cream keeps the calorie density and glycemic load very low.
- **Ingredients:** 200g Button Mushrooms (sliced), ½ cup Green Peas, 1 Onion (chopped), 1 cup tomato puree, 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ½ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan and add cumin seeds. Sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste until golden. Add tomato puree, turmeric, and salt; cook until the sauce thickens. Add the sliced mushrooms and green peas. Cook on medium heat for 8-10 minutes (mushrooms will release water). Stir in garam masala and serve.

37. Cabbage Poriyal (Stir-fry with coconut)

GI Rating: Low (15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** Cabbage is a cruciferous vegetable loaded with antioxidant polyphenols and sulfur compounds that improve pancreatic beta-cell function. Stir-frying it with mustard seeds, curry leaves, and a touch of fresh coconut adds healthy fats and fiber that keep blood sugar stable.
- **Ingredients:** 2 cups shredded Cabbage, 2 tbsp fresh grated Coconut, 1 tsp Mustard seeds, 1 tsp Urad dal, 1 Green Chilli, curry leaves, 1 tsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan, add mustard seeds, urad dal, green chilli, and curry leaves. Once the dal turns golden, add the shredded cabbage and salt. Sauté on medium-high heat for 5-6 minutes until the cabbage is cooked but still retains its crunch. Stir in the grated coconut and turn off the heat.

38. Tofu Tikka Skewers

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** Tofu is a low-carbohydrate, high-protein plant food containing soy isoflavones, which have been shown to improve insulin sensitivity and support weight management. Grilling it with capsicum and onions makes it a perfect low-glycemic dish.
- **Ingredients:** 200g firm Tofu (cubed), 1 Bell Pepper (cubed), 1 Onion (cubed), ½ cup yogurt (curd), 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp red chilli powder, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tsp Ghee.
- **Method:** Mix curd, ginger-garlic paste, red chilli powder, garam masala, and salt to make a marinade. Toss the tofu, bell pepper, and onion cubes in the marinade. Let it sit for 10 minutes. Thread onto skewers and cook on a hot tawa brushed with ghee, turning occasionally until all sides are golden brown and charred at the edges.

39. Moong Dal Khichdi (50% Dal, 50% Veggies, No Rice)

GI Rating: Low (35) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Traditional khichdi is rice-heavy and can spike blood sugar. This diabetic-friendly adaptation removes the rice entirely, using split green moong dal and non-starchy vegetables to create a comforting, fiber-dense, protein-rich dish that keeps blood sugar steady.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup split Green Moong Dal, 1 cup mixed chopped vegetables (carrots, French beans, cauliflower), ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ½ tsp Turmeric, 1 pinch Hing, 1 tsp Ghee, Salt, 2.5 cups water.
- **Method:** Wash and soak the moong dal for 15 minutes. Heat ghee in a pressure cooker and add cumin seeds and hing. Add the chopped vegetables and sauté for 2 minutes. Stir in the soaked dal, turmeric, salt, and water. Close the lid and pressure cook for 3 whistles. Mash slightly and serve warm.

40. Chicken Stew with Kerala Spices

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 25m

- **Why it works:** This light, comforting stew uses lean chicken breast and healthy coconut milk. Kerala spices like black pepper, cardamom, and cinnamon possess natural insulin-sensitizing properties that aid in glucose clearance from the blood.

- **Ingredients:** 250g Chicken breast (cubed), ½ cup light Coconut Milk, 1 cup chopped vegetables (carrots, beans), 1 onion (sliced), 1 tsp ginger paste, 2 cardamoms, 1 cinnamon stick, ½ tsp black pepper powder, 1 tsp Ghee, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat ghee in a pan, add cardamoms and cinnamon. Sauté onions and ginger paste until soft. Add the chicken and vegetables; sauté for 3-4 minutes. Pour in 1 cup of water and salt, cover, and cook on medium heat for 12-15 minutes until chicken is cooked. Lower the heat, stir in the coconut milk and black pepper, and simmer for just 2 minutes (do not boil after adding coconut milk).

41. Tindoori (Ivy Gourd) Fry

GI Rating: Very Low (15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Ivy Gourd (Tindora) has been shown in clinical trials to lower blood glucose levels due to its high fiber and low carbohydrate profile. Pan-frying it with digestive spices creates a dry, crunchy dish that pairs perfectly with low-GI rotis.
- **Ingredients:** 250g Ivy Gourd (Tindoori, sliced lengthwise), 1 onion (sliced), ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ½ tsp Turmeric, 1 tsp Coriander powder, 1 tbsp Oil, Salt to taste.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan and crackle the cumin seeds. Add the sliced onions and sauté for 2 minutes. Add the sliced ivy gourd, turmeric, and salt. Cover and cook on low-medium heat for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally. Remove the cover, add coriander powder, and cook for another 3-4 minutes on medium heat until the ivy gourd turns slightly crispy.

42. Zucchini Sabzi (Indian style)

GI Rating: Very Low (15) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** Zucchini is a non-starchy summer squash that is 95% water and extremely low-carb. Seasoned with cumin, turmeric, and green chilli, it makes a light, hydrating, and nutritious sabzi with an extremely low glycemic impact.
- **Ingredients:** 1 large Zucchini (chopped into cubes), 1 Tomato (chopped), ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ¼ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp Coriander powder, 1 Green Chilli (chopped), 1 tsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan, add cumin seeds and green chilli. Sauté for a few seconds, then add the tomato. Cook until soft. Stir in the zucchini cubes, turmeric, coriander powder, and salt. Cook uncovered on medium-high heat for 6-8 minutes, stirring frequently, until the zucchini is tender but still firm (avoid overcooking).

43. Egg Curry (Dhaba style, less oil)

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Boiled eggs provide high-quality protein and fats that digest slowly, preventing any sudden rise in glucose levels. The dhaba-style tomato-onion gravy uses minimal oil and no refined starches, making it a satisfying diabetic dinner.

- **Ingredients:** 3 Hard-boiled Eggs (peeled), 1 onion (chopped), 1 cup tomato puree, 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ½ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp Garam Masala, 1 tbsp Oil, Salt, fresh coriander.
- **Method:** Prick the boiled eggs with a toothpick. Heat oil in a pan, add cumin seeds, chopped onions, and ginger-garlic paste; sauté until golden. Add tomato puree, turmeric, and salt. Cook until the gravy thickens and oil separates. Pour in ½ cup of water, bring to a boil, and add the eggs. Simmer for 5 minutes, stir in garam masala, and garnish with coriander.

44. Mutton Rogan Josh (Lean cuts, avoid the fat)

GI Rating: Zero (0) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 45m

- **Why it works:** Lean cuts of mutton are high in protein, iron, and zinc. By trimming off the excess fat and using healthy spices like fennel powder (saunf) and ginger powder (saunth) without heavy cream or starchy thickeners, this dish provides pure protein and fat, ensuring zero glucose spikes.
- **Ingredients:** 250g lean Mutton (boneless), ½ cup Curd, 1 tsp Fennel powder, 1 tsp Ginger powder, 1 tsp Kashmiri Red Chilli powder, 1 Bay leaf, 2 Cloves, 1 tbsp Ghee, Salt to taste.
- **Method:** Heat ghee in a pressure cooker, add bay leaf and cloves. Add the mutton pieces and sear on high heat for 5 minutes until browned. Whisk curd with fennel powder, ginger powder, red chilli powder, and salt. Lower the heat, stir the curd mixture into the cooker, and mix well. Add ½ cup of water, close the lid, and cook for 5-6 whistles until the meat is tender.

45. Capsicum Besan Zunka

GI Rating: Low (30) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Capsicum (bell pepper) is loaded with carotenoids and Vitamin C, which improve antioxidant status in diabetics. Chickpea flour (besan) is used to coat the capsicum, adding complex carbs and protein while maintaining a low glycemic load.
- **Ingredients:** 2 medium Capsicums (chopped), ½ cup Besan, 1 onion (chopped), ½ tsp Mustard seeds, ½ tsp Turmeric, ½ tsp red chilli powder, 1 tbsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Dry roast besan in a pan for 3 minutes until aromatic and set aside. Heat oil in a pan, add mustard seeds and onions; sauté until translucent. Add capsicum and cook for 3-4 minutes. Stir in turmeric, red chilli powder, and salt. Sprinkle the roasted besan over the capsicum, along with 2-3 tablespoons of water. Cover and cook on low heat for 5 minutes until the besan is cooked and coats the capsicum.

46. Steamed Fish with Ginger and Soy

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 10) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Steaming fish preserves its delicate Omega-3 fatty acids, which help reduce insulin resistance. The addition of ginger stimulates gastric emptying and improves glucose uptake into muscle tissue, helping lower circulating blood sugar.

- **Ingredients:** 250g Fish fillets (like Sea Bass or Pomfret), 1 tbsp ginger (sliced into matchsticks), 2 spring onions (sliced), 1 tbsp low-sodium Soy sauce, 1 tsp sesame oil, 1 tbsp lemon juice.
- **Method:** Place the fish fillets on a heatproof plate that fits in a steamer. Scatter ginger matchsticks and half the spring onions over the fish. Drizzle with soy sauce and lemon juice. Steam on high heat for 10-12 minutes until the fish flakes easily. Drizzle with sesame oil and garnish with the remaining spring onions before serving.

47. Spinach & Tofu Bhurji

GI Rating: Very Low (12) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** This vegan scramble features tofu and spinach. Tofu is low-carb and high-protein, while spinach provides fiber, iron, and magnesium. This mineral-rich combination helps optimize insulin sensitivity and glucose uptake.
- **Ingredients:** 150g firm Tofu (crumbled), 1 cup chopped fresh Spinach, 1 onion (chopped), ½ tsp Cumin seeds, ¼ tsp Turmeric, 1 Green Chilli, 1 tsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan and add cumin seeds. Sauté onions and green chilli until soft. Add chopped spinach and cook for 2 minutes until wilted. Stir in the crumbled tofu, turmeric, and salt. Cook on medium heat, stirring constantly, for 4-5 minutes until heated through.

48. Chana Saag (Chickpeas cooked in mustard greens)

GI Rating: Low (28) | Prep: 10m (with boiled chana) | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Chickpeas (Chana) contain slowly digestible starch and resistant starch, which release glucose gradually over several hours. Cooking them in a nutrient-dense, fiber-packed puree of mustard greens (Saag) minimizes the glycemic impact.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup boiled Chickpeas (Kabuli Chana), 2 cups Mustard greens or Spinach (pureed), 1 Onion (chopped), 1 tsp Ginger-Garlic paste, ½ tsp Cumin powder, 1 tsp Oil, Salt.
- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan, sauté onions and ginger-garlic paste. Add the pureed greens, cumin powder, and salt. Cook for 5 minutes. Stir in the boiled chickpeas and ½ cup of water. Simmer on low heat for 10-12 minutes until the gravy coats the chickpeas.

49. Stir-fried Beans with Garlic

GI Rating: Low (20) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** French beans are highly fibrous and low in carbohydrates. Quick stir-frying preserves their prebiotic fibers, which feed beneficial gut bacteria. The active component in garlic, allicin, helps lower blood sugar and improve lipid profiles.
- **Ingredients:** 200g French beans (ends trimmed and cut into 2-inch pieces), 4 cloves of Garlic (finely chopped), ½ tsp mustard seeds, 1 dry red chilli, 1 tsp Oil, Salt.

- **Method:** Heat oil in a pan, add mustard seeds, dry red chilli, and chopped garlic. Sauté until garlic turns aromatic. Add the French beans and salt. Stir-fry on medium-high heat for 6-8 minutes until the beans are tender but still crisp.

50. Lauki Chana Dal

GI Rating: Low (25) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Bengal gram (Chana Dal) has one of the lowest glycemic indices among lentils. Pairing it with hydrating, high-fiber, low-calorie bottle gourd (Lauki) creates a highly filling, nutrient-dense stew that prevents sugar spikes.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup Chana Dal, 1.5 cups Bottle Gourd (Lauki, cut into cubes), 1 Onion (chopped), 1 Tomato (chopped), ½ tsp Turmeric, 1 tsp Cumin seeds, 1 tsp Ghee, Salt, 2 cups water.
- **Method:** Soak chana dal for 1 hour. In a pressure cooker, heat ghee and crackle cumin seeds. Sauté onions until soft. Add tomatoes, turmeric, and salt; cook until soft. Add the soaked chana dal, bottle gourd cubes, and 2 cups of water. Close the lid and pressure cook for 3-4 whistles. Fluff slightly before serving.